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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) / MGU-BBA (HONOURS) / MGU-BCA (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION – OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

MG5DSCSMG300 – SPORTS FAN ENGAGEMENT AND TICKETING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

PART A – SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (2 marks each)

Answer any 10 questions.

1. A sports team has young fans who mainly follow matches through social media and mobile platforms. Identify one suitable basis for segmenting this fan group.

Answer: Behavioural segmentation based on digital media usage is suitable, as these fans regularly engage with sports content through social media and mobile platforms.

2. What does social media engagement rate indicate about sports fans?

Answer: Social media engagement rate indicates the level of interaction fans have with content through likes, comments, shares, clicks and other responses relative to the audience or reach.

3. A sports club receives a large number of social-media interactions after introducing a new fan activity. What does this result indicate about the initiative?

Answer: It indicates that the initiative has attracted fan attention and encouraged interaction. It may suggest that the activity is relevant and engaging to the target audience.

4. A sports event sells tickets through its website, box office and authorized partners. Why is it important to keep the ticket inventory updated across all these channels?

Answer: Updating ticket inventory prevents overselling and double booking. It ensures accurate availability information across all sales channels and improves customer satisfaction.

5. Expand NFC and state its use in sports ticketing.

Answer: NFC stands for Near Field Communication. It enables contactless ticket validation and entry when a compatible ticket or device is tapped near a reader.

6. Define sports fandom.

Answer: Sports fandom is the emotional attachment, loyalty and interest that an individual develops towards a sports team, athlete, club or sport.

7. Mention any two types of personal data that a sports organization may collect from fans.

Answer: Examples: name and contact details; purchase history or ticketing information. Other acceptable answers include age, location, preferences and consent-based engagement data.

8. What is ticket fraud?

Answer: Ticket fraud refers to the use, sale or distribution of counterfeit, invalid or deceptively marketed tickets to obtain money or unauthorized event access.

9. Why is convenience important in creating a positive fan experience?

Answer: Convenience makes ticket purchasing, venue entry, access to information and participation easier. It reduces delays and frustration, improving overall fan satisfaction.

10. What is meant by continuous improvement?

Answer: Continuous improvement is the ongoing process of evaluating performance, collecting feedback, identifying weaknesses and making changes to improve services and outcomes.

11. How can ticket sales data help a sports organization?

Answer: Ticket sales data helps identify demand patterns, popular matches, customer preferences and sales trends. It supports pricing, promotional planning and attendance forecasting.

12. Mention any two revenue streams, other than media rights, that can support a sports organization.

Answer: Examples: sponsorship and advertising; ticket sales. Other acceptable answers include merchandise, licensing, hospitality packages, membership fees and concessions.

PART B – SHORT ESSAY QUESTIONS (5 marks each)

Answer any 6 questions.

13. Analyse how different media options influence fan behaviour and expectations.

Fans use live streaming, match highlights and mobile content to follow sports conveniently across different platforms. Live streaming provides real-time excitement and a sense of participation. Highlights allow fans to revisit important moments, while mobile content offers quick updates, statistics and personalised information. These options encourage frequent engagement and allow fans to consume content according to their preferences. Consequently, fans increasingly expect convenient access, timely updates, interactive features and consistent content across platforms.

14. Describe any five promotional techniques that sports organizations can use to create excitement among fans.

1. Social media campaigns: engaging posts, videos, contests and match updates.
2. Discounts and special offers: early-bird tickets, group discounts and promotional packages.
3. Giveaways and competitions: merchandise, signed jerseys and match-day prizes.
4. Influencer and athlete promotions: athletes and sports personalities promote events.
5. Fan events: meet-and-greet sessions, interactive activities and pre-match entertainment.

15. Explain the importance of digital ticketing platforms in the modern sports industry.

Digital ticketing platforms enable fans to purchase and access tickets through websites and mobile applications. They simplify booking, reduce dependence on physical tickets and provide convenient entry through electronic verification. These platforms help organizations monitor ticket sales, update availability, communicate with customers and analyse purchasing patterns. They can also improve security through QR codes, electronic validation and controlled ticket distribution.

16. Explain how integrating data from different sources can help an organization make better fan-engagement decisions.

Integrating ticketing, attendance, social-media and customer data provides a comprehensive understanding of fan behaviour. Ticketing data identifies purchasing preferences, attendance records reveal actual participation, social-media data measures online engagement, and customer data helps identify individual preferences. By combining these sources, organizations can segment fans, personalise promotions, improve event planning, evaluate campaigns and develop stronger

relationships with supporters. Data collection and integration should follow appropriate privacy and consent requirements.

17. Explain the importance of effective customer service in building long-term relationships with sports fans.

Effective customer service helps fans resolve booking problems, obtain accurate information and receive timely assistance. It improves satisfaction and builds trust between fans and sports organizations. Responsive communication, courteous staff, accessible support channels and efficient complaint resolution create positive experiences. Consistent service encourages repeat attendance, strengthens loyalty and promotes positive word-of-mouth recommendations.

18. Explain the importance of community building in sports fan engagement.

Community building creates opportunities for fans to interact and develop a shared identity around a team or sport. Online fan groups, supporter clubs, community events and interactive discussions encourage participation. A strong fan community increases emotional attachment, strengthens loyalty and encourages fans to share experiences. It also provides organizations with feedback, promotes inclusive participation and supports long-term engagement.

19. Explain the major stages in the development of the modern sports industry.

Indicative answer: The modern sports industry developed through several broad stages. Initially, sports were largely community-based recreational and competitive activities. The development of organized clubs, associations and formal competitions introduced structured management and governance. The expansion of professional sports created paid athletes, commercial competitions and sponsorship opportunities. Television and other broadcasting technologies expanded audiences and generated media revenue. In the digital era, social media, streaming services, data analytics and online ticketing have transformed fan engagement and commercial operations.

20. Explain the concept of dynamic pricing in sports ticketing and identify the factors that can influence ticket prices.

Dynamic pricing is a ticketing strategy in which ticket prices change according to demand, availability and market conditions. Prices may increase when demand is high and decrease when demand is low. Factors include team popularity, match importance, opponent strength, venue capacity, seating category, time remaining before the event and current ticket sales. Organizations use

dynamic pricing to manage demand and maximise revenue while considering transparency and fan affordability.

PART C – ESSAY QUESTIONS (10 marks each)

Answer any 2 questions.

21. Explain the different marketing and communication channels used by sports organizations, including traditional media, social media, websites, mobile applications, streaming platforms, and direct communication.

Sports organizations use traditional and digital channels to communicate with fans, promote events and develop long-term relationships.

1. Traditional media: Television, radio and newspapers reach large audiences and provide match coverage, interviews, advertisements and sports news.
2. Social media: Instagram, Facebook, YouTube and X allow organizations to publish updates, videos, behind-the-scenes content and interactive posts, encouraging comments and sharing.
3. Official websites: Provide fixtures, results, team profiles, ticket sales, merchandise and club announcements.
4. Mobile applications: Deliver personalised notifications, live scores, digital tickets, statistics and exclusive content.
5. Streaming platforms: Live streaming and on-demand services allow fans to watch matches, highlights and interviews across locations and devices.
6. Direct communication: Email newsletters, SMS alerts and consent-based messaging provide ticket offers, event reminders and personalised updates.

Using these channels together helps organizations reach different fan groups, maintain consistent communication, measure engagement and strengthen loyalty.

22. Explain the concept of secondary ticketing markets. Describe their positive and negative impacts on sports fans and sports organizations with reference to ticket prices, accessibility, consumer protection, and unauthorized resale.

Secondary ticketing markets involve the resale of tickets after their initial purchase from the primary seller. These transactions may occur through authorized resale platforms, ticket exchanges or unauthorized resellers.

Positive impacts:

1. Flexibility: Fans who cannot attend may resell tickets.
2. Availability: Resale platforms may help fans locate tickets when primary sales are sold out.
3. Inventory circulation: Unused tickets can reach other interested fans.
4. Organizational opportunities: Official resale systems can help organizations monitor transactions and control ticket transfers.

Negative impacts:

1. Higher prices: Resellers may charge more than the original ticket price.
2. Reduced accessibility: High prices may prevent ordinary fans from attending.
3. Ticket fraud: Counterfeit, duplicated or invalid tickets may be sold through unreliable channels.
4. Consumer protection concerns: Buyers may face unclear refund policies, hidden charges or difficulties obtaining assistance.
5. Reputation risks: Unfair resale practices can damage organizational trust.

Organizations can respond through authorized resale platforms, secure ticket verification, transparent pricing, clear refund procedures and measures against fraudulent sales.

23. A professional sports league wants to increase fan engagement before, during, and after its matches. Discuss and explain a gamification strategy using suitable game mechanics, participation activities, and rewards to encourage continuous fan interaction.

Gamification applies game elements such as points, challenges, leaderboards, badges and rewards to encourage participation.

1. Pre-match: Fans predict results, select fantasy teams, take quizzes and vote for favourite players. Points can be awarded for participation and correct predictions.
2. During the match: Apps can offer live trivia, score predictions, player-performance challenges and polls.
3. Post-match: Fans can review the match, vote for player of the match, answer quizzes and share experiences.
4. Game mechanics: Points, badges, achievement levels, streaks and leaderboards encourage continued participation. Team challenges promote friendly competition.
5. Rewards: Merchandise discounts, exclusive digital content, match-day experiences and recognition can motivate fans.
6. Personalisation and evaluation: Challenges can be tailored to fan preferences. Participation rates, repeat interactions, app usage and reward redemption can be monitored.

The strategy should be inclusive, easy to use, fair and transparent, encouraging meaningful participation rather than focusing only on rewards.

24. A professional sports club wants to use social media to build closer relationships with its fans. Based on standard sports marketing strategies, explain how the club can use different platforms, content types, interaction methods, and participation incentives to achieve this goal.

Social media enables sports clubs to communicate directly with fans, share exclusive content and encourage participation.

1. Platform selection: Instagram for photographs, reels and stories; YouTube for interviews, highlights and longer videos; Facebook for community discussions and event updates; and X for live commentary and immediate announcements.
2. Content creation: Publish match highlights, training videos, athlete interviews, behind-the-scenes footage, historical moments and community activities.
3. Interactive communication: Polls, quizzes, question-and-answer sessions, live chats and discussions encourage two-way communication. Responding to comments helps build trust.
4. Fan participation: Invite supporters to submit photographs, share match-day experiences, vote for player of the match and join creative challenges.
5. Incentives: Giveaways, merchandise discounts, recognition and exclusive digital content can motivate participation.
6. Personalisation: Tailor content to fan interests and preferred platforms while respecting privacy and consent.
7. Evaluation: Monitor engagement rate, reach, shares, comments, video views, follower growth and link clicks.

A successful strategy combines relevant content, regular interaction, participation and evaluation to build a loyal fan community.

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